



IN THIS STONE CARVING, A COUPLE HOLD HANDS AND EXCHANGE VOWS AT THEIR WEDDING. THE GROOM HOLDS THE MARRIAGE CONTRACT IN HIS HAND.

father had decided who she was going to marry! An engagement party was held at which the girl was given a betrothal ring by

her fiancé, and he received a dowry (a gift of money) from her father. June was thought to be the best time to hold a wedding, since it was the month of the goddess Juno, whose duty it was to protect marriages. At the ceremony, the couple signed a contract to pledge themselves to each other, prayers were said, and sacrifices were offered to the gods. After enjoying a feast of food and wine, the couple went to live in the groom's house.

